1. MPLADS funds must be used to create durable assets like physical infrastructure for health, education, etc.
2. A specified portion of each MP's fund must benefit SC/ST populations.
3. MPLADS funds are sanctioned on yearly basis and the unused funds cannot be carried forward to the next year.
4. The district authority must inspect at least 10% of all works under implementation every year.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Ans. (d) : Statement 1 is correct; members of parliament local area development schemes is for development works and the creation of durable community assets. The emphasis is the creation of durable community assets based on locally felt needs in the areas of roads, electricity, drinking water, health and education etc.

Development of areas inhabited by scheduled caste and scheduled tribes, MPs are to recommend every year work costing at least 15 percent of the MPLADS entitlement for the year for areas inhabited by schedule caste population and 7.5 percent for areas inhabited by S.T. population. In other words, Rs. 75 lakhs for the S.C. population. In case there is insufficient tribal population in the area of Lok Sabha members, they may recommend this amount for the creation of community assets in tribal areas outside of their constituency but within their state of election. In case a state does not have S.T. inhabited area this amount may be utilised in S.C. Therefore, statement 2 is correct.

MPLADS funds are non-lapsable; funds released to the district authority by the Government of India are non-lapsable. Funds left in the district can be carried forward for utilization in the subsequent years. Therefore, statement 3 is not correct.

Role of the district authority, the district authority's role has been outlined in different paragraphs of the MPLADS guidelines. The district authority would be responsible for overall coordination and supervision of the works under the scheme at the district level and inspect at least 10% of the works under implementation every year. Therefore, statement 4 is correct.

43. A constitutional government by definition is a–

(a) government by legislature
(b) popular government
(c) multi-party government
(d) limited government

Ans. (d) : Constitutional government is defined by the existence of a Constitution, which may be a legal instrument or merely a set of fixed norms generally accepted as the fundamental law of the polity, that effectively controls the exercise of political power. The essence of constitutionalism is the control of power by its distribution among several state organs or offices in such a way that they are each subjected to reciprocal controls and forced to cooperate, in formulating the will of the state. Constitutional government, in essence, is about constitutionalism which is about limited government. In many cases, the constitutional government uses "constitutionally limited government" or "limited government".

ECONOMICS

• Economic Planning and National Income/ Budget

44. With reference to the Indian economy after the 1991 economic liberalization, consider the following statements:

1. Worker productivity (₹ per worker at 2004-05 prices) increased in urban areas while it decreased in rural areas.
2. The percentage share of rural areas in the workforce steadily increased.
3. In rural areas, the growth in non-farm economy increased.
4. The growth rate in rural employment decreased.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Ans. (b): Statement 1 is incorrect: Productivity is a measure of the efficiency with which resources, both human and material, are converted into goods and services. There is a wide disparity in worker productivity between rural and urban areas. India's labour productivity grew by over 14 percent every year. But between the financial years of 2011 and 2015, this rate fell to just half of that (7.4%) and continued its declaration to just 3.7 percent between financial years of 2016 and 2018.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The rate of growth in population and workforce during the last four decades in rural areas have always been lower than of the urban areas.

Statement 3 is correct: Rural non-farm economy in recent times, is considered as an effectual strategy for decentralisation of economic activities to rural India.

The economic census of India estimates that around 41.89 million rural people are employed in the non-agricultural establishments which registered a growth rate of 4.56% during 1998-2005.

Statement 4 is correct : As per the census 2011, 68.8 percent of countries population and 72.4 percent of workforce resided in rural areas. However, the steady transition to urbanisation over the years is leading to the decline in the rural share in population, workforce and GDP of the country.

• Agriculture, Industry and Trade

45. What are the advantages of fertigation in agriculture?

1. Controlling the alkalinity of irrigation water is possible.
2. Efficient application of Rock Phosphate and all other phosphatic fertilizer is possible.
3. Increased availability of nutrients to plants is possible.
4. Reduction in the leaching of chemical nutrients is possible.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Ans. (c) : Statement 1 is correct: Fertigation can control the alkalinity of irrigation water.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Efficient application of all phosphatic fertilizers is not possible.

Statement 3 is correct: Increased availability of nutrients to plants is possible.

Statement 4 is correct: Reduction in leaching is possible.

46. What is/are the advantage/advantages of zero tillage in agriculture?

1. Sowing of wheat is possible without burning the residue of previous crop.
2. Without the need for nursery of rice saplings, direct planting of paddy seeds in the wet soil is possible.
3. Carbon sequestration in the soil is possible.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : Zero tillage is the process of agriculture that promotes conservation sustainable agriculture. Here the soil is not tilled and left with at least 30% of cover over the soil, which may be a previous crop. When wheat seeds are sown in soil using a happy seeder, the rice stalks act as mulch. It prevents harmful gases that are released when stubbles are burnt, provides enhanced nutrients and improves moisture holding capacity of the soil. The same is also true for rice when it is directly sown without transplantation. As the soil is not tilled, the remains of previous crops hold carbon and prevent it from entering the atmosphere as carbon dioxide. All statements are correct.

47. With reference to pulse production in India, consider the following statements:

1. Black gram can be cultivated as both kharif and rabi crop.
2. Green-gram alone accounts for nearly half of pulse production.
3. In the last three decades, while the production of kharif pulses has increased, the production of rabi pulses has decreased.

Which of the statement given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : During Kharif, Black Gram is cultivated throughout the country. It is best suited to rice fallows during rabi in southern and south-eastern parts of India. Blackgram needs relatively heavier soils than green gram. So, statement 1 is correct.

Gram is the most dominant pulse having a share of around 40 percent in the total production, followed by Tur/Arhar at 15 to 20 percent and Urad/Black Matpe and Moong (Green gram) at around 8-10 percent each. Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka are the top five pulses producing states. The Productivity of pulses is 764 kg/ha. So, statement 2 is not correct.

In the last three decades, the production of kharif pulses first decreased then increased and the production of rabi, pulses production has also increased. So, statement 3 is not correct.

48. With reference to the current trends in the cultivation of sugarcane in India, consider the following statements:

1. A substantial saving in seed material is made when 'bud chip settlings' are raised in a nursery and transplanted in the main field.
2. When direct planting of setts is done, the germination percentage is better with single-budded setts as compared to setts with many buds.
3. If bad weather conditions prevail when setts are directly planted, single-budded setts have better survival as compared to large setts.
4. Sugarcane can be cultivated using settling prepared from tissue culture.